

If you have a brand-name product you buy over and over again, there's almost always a coupon available for it. Buy the Sunday paper or browse Coupons.com—even a quick Google search limited to the last week will bring up hundreds of results. You can also stretch your dollars even further if you match your coupon with a store sale or special gift card offer.

Although I've never scored a completely free bottle of shampoo or conditioner, I *have* saved some serious money on higher end items. I even bought four bottles of my favorite hairspray once because I had a couple coupons with me and there was a \$5 gift card promo involved too. It only takes a few minutes to clip and scan the current week's ads, and since they're products you would use anyway, it's worth the minimal effort.

If you consider yourself a little more daring and don't mind trying different brands, sign up for FREE beauty samples at MoneySavingMom.com and Freebies4Mom.com. They offer mini packets of shampoo, conditioner, color creams, and styling products that don't cost anything but your name and email address. Most samples take between four to six weeks to be sent, but you should be able to get two or three uses out of them when they finally arrive!

READER TIP:

Those high-end shampoos are so worth it, but like all shampoos they are super concentrated. To get way more mileage out of that bottle, take an empty clean shampoo bottle with a flip top and fill it 1/3 to 1/2 full with shampoo. Top it off with lukewarm water and gently shake. Use this to wash your hair. Not only will it last longer, it is also better for your hair and will distribute more evenly.

—Monique, Netherlands

5. BE RESOURCEFUL

Have you ever read the directions on the back of your shampoo bottle? Most of them encourage you to lather, rinse, and repeat, but one cycle is